

Iринi Amanaki

irini.amanaki@nyu.edu

10 Washington Place New York, NY 10003

Education

2025 –	New York University, Ph.D. in Linguistics
2020 – 2024	University of Crete, Master's Program in Linguistics (GPA: 9.59/10) Thesis title: <i>The development of wishes in child Greek</i> Supervisor: Vina Tsakali
2015 – 2020	University of Crete, Bachelors of Philology (GPA 8.88/10) Specialization: Linguistics
2018	University of Amsterdam, Erasmus + exchange student Courses attended: Neurolinguistics, Philosophy of Mathematics, Evil in Thought and Literature, Stylistics

Further Education

Summer Schools

2024	6 th Crete Summer School of Linguistics (<i>CreteLing2024</i>) University of Crete
2023	5 th CreteLing, Crete Summer School of Linguistics (<i>CreteLing2023</i>) University of Crete
2022	4 th CreteLing, Crete Summer School of Linguistics (<i>CreteLing2022</i>) University of Crete
2022	V-NYI #5, Virtual Summer School in Linguistics, Cognition and Culture NY-St. Petersburg Institute of Linguistics, Cognition and Culture (NYI)
2021	V-NYI #3, Virtual Summer School in Linguistics, Cognition and Culture NY-St. Petersburg Institute of Linguistics, Cognition and Culture (NYI)
2019	3 rd CreteLing, Crete Summer School of Linguistics (<i>CreteLing2019</i>) University of Crete
2018	2 nd CreteLing, Crete Summer School of Linguistics (<i>CreteLing2018</i>) University of Crete
2017	1 st CreteLing, Crete Summer School of Linguistics (<i>CreteLing2017</i>) University of Crete

Online Education

2022	<i>Special Needs Education</i> , Training and Lifelong Learning Center of the University of Macedonia
2021	<i>Storytelling for Social Change</i> , MichiganX - Storytelling101x, Edx
2020	<i>PredictionX: Omens, Oracles & Prophecies</i> , HarvardX: SOC1.practx, Edx

Workshop

2024	<i>OLIVE-R: Open Linguistic Investigation and Variable Exploration with R</i> . Instructor: Onur Özsoy. In the context of the research project Directive Speech Acts in child and adult language: The role of form and prosody (DireSpeech)
------	--

Awards

- | | |
|------|---|
| 2025 | New York University's Graduate School of Arts and Science MacCracken Award (5-year Fellowship). |
| 2020 | Certification for being the highest-ranked student among the graduates of the School of Philosophy in 2019 – 2020, University of Crete. |

Research experience and service

Research Experience

- | | |
|-----------------|---|
| 10.2025-04.2026 | Graduate Research Assistant of Prof. Ailis Cournane. Job description: create stimuli for a language acquisition study involving working with Adobe Draw on the lab iPad. |
| 01 – 04. 2025 | Erasmus + Intern at the University of Milan – Bicocca. Main project: The acquisition of the mental attitude verbs <i>know</i> and <i>think</i> : literature review and experimental design. Advisor: Maria Teresa Guasti. Other duties: (1) image generation for a language acquisition project, (2) translation to Greek and recording of the testing sentences of the Leibnizdream – H06 Relative Clause study, (3) study and summary of language acquisition papers. |
| 03 – 05. 2024 | Research Assistant in <i>DireSpeech</i> Research project: <i>Interpreting Directive Speech Acts in child and adult language: The role of form and Prosody</i> . Principal Investigator: Despina Oikonomou. University of Crete (website) |
| 05 – 11. 2023 | Research Assistant in <i>Varlphon</i> Research project: <i>Variation, input frequency and norm in the phonological development of Greek as first Language (L1)</i> . Principal Investigator: Ioanna Kappa. University of Crete (website) |

Academic Service

- | | |
|-------------|---|
| 2026 – 2027 | Co-secretary (with Jonathan Merchan) of the NYU Linguistics Association (LANYU). |
| 2017 – 2024 | Volunteer for CreteLing Summer School, CreteLing2017-CreteLing2024: assistantship to the Organizing Committee |
| 2023 & 2024 | Dorm master (Xenia Dorms) in CreteLing 2023 and CreteLing2024 |
| 2024 | Language consultant (as a native speaker of Greek) for a questionnaire study on modality in the project “Logic in Semantic Universals” at the University of Edinburgh: Uegaki, Wataru & Mucha, Anne & Hannon, Ella & Engels, James & Whibley, Fred. 2024. Cross-linguistic dataset of force-flavor combinations in modal elements. Linguistic Variation, here |
| 2023 | Member of the voluntary student group for the Computational Phylogenetics and language (Pre)history Workshop: Achievements, Challenges and Prospects, 23 – 25 May 2023, University of Crete |

- 2022 Member of the organizing committee for the Working on Linguistics2@UoC workshop (Workshop for the original work of the graduate students at the University of Crete).
- 2020 Participation in the human annotation experiment for: Aditi Chaudhary, Antonios Anastasopoulos, Zaid Sheikh, Graham Neubig. 2021. Reducing Confusion in Active Learning for Part-Of-Speech Tagging. *Transactions of the Association for Computational Linguistics*; 9 1–16, [here](#).

Publications

- 2025 Oikonomou, D., Tsakali, V. P., Gatsou, M., Vassileiou, B., Kaniadaki, M., Karatzanou, D., & Amanaki, I. (2025). Fantasy Play and the Language of Emplotment in Greek L1 Children. In *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society* (Vol. 47). [here](#)
- 2025 Amanaki Irini & Vina Tsakali. “I wish I was blue!': The development of (un)attainable desires in child Greek'. In *the Proceedings of the 49th Annual Boston University Conference on Language Development* (BUCLD49), November 7-10, 2024, Boston University. [here](#)
- To appear Amanaki Irini. 'Oreos and oreá as cases of language change in Modern Greek'. 1st Workshop for graduate students at the University of Crete, Working on Linguistics1@UoC. University of Crete
- 2024 Tsakali, Vina & Irini Amanaki. 'Simple and Directive Subjunctive Conditionals in Child Greek'. In *the Proceedings of the 48th Annual Boston University Conference on Language Development* (BUCLD48), edited by Hayat Abdullah Ali and Jupitara Ray, pp. 638-648. [here](#)
- 2024 Ploumídi, Eirini, Ioanna Kappa, Eirini Amanaki, & Eirini Giannikouri. 'Studying phonological acquisition: Data collection method'. In Dimitris Michelioudakis, Alexandros Tantos, & Konstantina Tsiousia (Eds.), *Studies in Greek Linguistics 43* (pp. 505-514). Institute of Modern Greek Studies (Manolis Triandaphyllidis Foundation), [here](#)
- 2022 Amanaki, E., Bernardy, J-P., Chatzikyriakidis, St., Cooper, R., Dobnik, S., Karimi, A., Ek, A., Giannikouri, E.C., Katsouli, V., Kolokousis, I., Mamatzaki, E.C., Papadakis, D., Petrova, O., Psaltaki, E., Skoulataki, E., Soupiona, Ch., Stefanidou, Chr.. 'Fine-grained Entailment: Resources for Greek and Precise Entailment'. *Proceedings of the Workshop on Dataset Creation for Lower Resourced Languages within the 13th Language Resources and Evaluation Conference*, DCLRL 2022, [here](#)

Presentations

- 06.10.2026 Despina Oikonomou, Vina Tsakali, Mary Baltazani, Katerina Iliopoulou, Irini Amanaki, Manuela Genitsaridi, Mary Kaniadaki, Danae Karatzanou, Marina Mastrokosta. *Distinguishing between request and permission in directives: Children's acquisition of lexical and prosodic cues*. Talk at Experiments in Linguistics Meaning Conference (ELM 4), at UPenn, Philadelphia.
- 30.10.2025 Irini Amanaki. *The development of desires in child language*. Presentation at Conceptual Development and Social Cognition Lab Rhodes. Department of Psychology, New York University, New York.
- 25.10.2025 Irini Amanaki. *'I want! I want!': The development of (un)attainable desires in child Greek*. Presentation at LAWNE workshop. Yale University, New Haven.
- 23.09.2025 Oikonomou, Despina, Vina Tsakali, Maria Gatsou, Katerina Iliopoulou, Vasiliou, Irini Amanaki, Mary Kaniadaki, Danae Karatzanou. *'Grammar in fantasy play in L1-Greek Child Speech'*. Talk at the 17th International Conference on Greek Linguistics (ICGL), 23-26 September 2025, University of Cambridge, U.K.
- 02.08.2025 Despina Oikonomou, Vina Tsakali, Maria Gatsou, Benedict Vassileiou, Mary Kaniadaki, Danae Karatzanou & Irini Amanaki. *'Fantasy Play and the Language of Emplotment in Greek L1 Children'*. Poster presentation in CogSci 2025 Conference, San Francisco, CA.
- 04.05.2025 Vina Tsakali, Despina Oikonomou, Maria Gatsou, Katerina Iliopoulou, Benedict Vassileiou, Marina Mastrokosta, Mary Kaniadaki, Danae Karatzanou & Irini Amanaki. *'The development of Mood and Aspect in Greek Directive Speech Acts'*. AMGL45, May 2-4, 2025, Aristotle University, Thessaloniki.
- 09.11.2024 Amanaki Irini & Vina Tsakali. *'I wish I was blue!': The development of (un)attainable desires in child Greek'*. Poster presentation. 49th Annual Boston University Conference on Language Development (BUCLD49), November 7-10, 2024, Boston University
- 13.09.2024 Tsakali Vina, Despina Oikonomou & Irini Amanaki. *'Conditional reasoning in teleological directives in Greek: Evidence from child language'*. Poster presentation. 16th Generative Approaches to Language Acquisition (GALA) Conference, September 12-14, 2024, NOVA University of Lisbon – School of Social Sciences and Humanities (NOVA FCSH)
- 22.07.2024 Amanaki Irini & Vina Tsakali. *'The development of desires and wishes in child Greek'*. Poster presentation. 6th Crete Summer School of Linguistics, CreteLing, July 13-26 2024, University of Crete
- 04.11.2023 Tsakali Vina & Irini Amanaki. *'Simple and Subjunctives Conditionals in*

- child Greek'. Poster presentation. 48th Annual Boston University Conference on Language Development (BUCLD48), November 2-5, 2023, Boston University
- 20.07.2023 Tsakali Vina & Irini Amanaki. 'Child comprehension of Simple Conditionals and Directive Subjunctives'. Poster presentation. 5th Crete Summer School of Linguistics, CreteLing. July 15-28, 2023, University of Crete
- 05.05.2023 Tsakali Vina & Irini Amanaki, 'The development of If-future clauses and Subjunctive Conditionals in Greek'. 43rd Annual Meeting of the Department of Linguistics. May 4-7, 2023, Aristotle University of Thessaloniki
- 05.05.2023 Ploumidi Eirini, Ioanna Kappa, Eirini Amanaki, Ioanna Chrisoulaki, Eirini Giannikouri, Maria Kanli, Maria Karouzou-Mathioudaki, Vasiliki Katsouli, Christina Mousga, Ilia Nikoloudaki & Dimitris Papadakis. 'Studying phonological acquisition: Collecting longitudinal data that result in fine-grained research findings'. 43rd Annual Meeting of the Department of Linguistics. May 4-7, 2023, Aristotle University of Thessaloniki
- 24.06.2022 Amanaki, E., Bernardy, J-P., Chatzikyriakidis, St., Cooper, R., Dobnik, S., Karimi, A., Ek, A., Giannikouri, E.C., Katsouli, V., Kolokousis, I., Mamatzaki, E.C., Papadakis, D., Petrova, O., Psaltaki, E., Skoulataki, E., Soupiona, Ch., Stefanidou, Chr.. 'Fine-grained Entailment: Resources for Greek and Precise Entailment'. Workshop on Dataset Creation for Lower Resourced Languages (LREC) within the 13th Language Resources and Evaluation Conference (DCLRL). June 24, 2022
- 24.09.2021 Amanaki Irini. 'Orea as a case of language change and grammaticalization in Modern Greek'. 1st Workshop for graduate students at the University of Crete, Working on Linguistics1@UoC, September 24, 2021, University of Crete

Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistantship in Linguistics

New York University

- 2026 (Spring) LING-PSYCH-UA 59 First Language Acquisition
Instructor: Ailis Cournane

University of Crete

- 2022 (Fall) GLOF165 Introduction to Syntax
Instructor: Elena Anagnostopoulou
- 2022 (Spring) GLOF175 Levels of Grammar
Instructor: Vina Tsakali
- 2022 (Spring) GLOF211 Minimalist Syntax
Instructor: Elena Anagnostopoulou
- 2021 (Fall) GLOF165 Introduction to Syntax
Instructor: Elena Anagnostopoulou
- 2021 (Spring) GLOF175 Levels of Grammar
Instructor: Vina Tsakali

2021 (Spring) GLOF111 Syntax II
Instructor: Elena Anagnostopoulou

Teaching Internship

02 – 06.2019 Teaching Intern at the Experimental Junior High School of Heraklion
Final project: *Teaching compounding in Modern Greek through Music*

Tutoring

2016 – 2020 Voluntary tutor for primary and secondary school students
2016 Voluntary Syntax tutor for undergraduate students

Skills

Languages Greek (native), English (proficient), German (intermediate), Spanish (beginner), Ancient Greek (reading knowledge)

Software PCIBex - open-source online experiment builder, ELAN - linguistic annotator

Programming R (beginner)

Music Konnakol, playing the bendir/ frame drum

Interests

2026 **Performance as a way of investigating identity.** Participant at the Workshop: *Performing Narratives | Performing Personal Narratives ME AND YOU - Performance as a Way of Knowing*. NYU Tisch School of the Arts. New York. Instructor: Anna Deavere Smith ([website](#))

2023 - 2025 **Learning about folk Mediterranean music and its history.** Member of the amateur vocal group 'Cojam'. Heraklion, Crete. Instructor: Maria Koti.

2021 – 2023 **Music curation and storytelling through the radio.** Amateur radio producer at the webradio <https://owlradio.gr/>.

2019 – 2023 **Exploring rhythm through percussion and using it as a tool for education.** Participant in the program Rhythm4edu, University of Crete. Volunteer instructor for the warm-up exercises during Covid-19 through the platform <https://rhythm4edu.coursevo.com/>. Rethimnon and Heraklion, Crete. Instructors: Yiannis Papatzanis, Anthi Fourki.

2019 – 2020 **Hiking.** Volunteer in the student hiking group "Propato stin Kriti". Rethimnon, Crete.